

EFY EXPO 2012

A Big Show, Resulting In Bigger Business

Under the cloud of a global economic slowdown and the depreciating rupee, everyone thought that organising an electronics exposition would be a bad idea. Yet, EFY proved this wrong. *EFY Expo 2012* demonstrated that the Indian electronics industry knows the art of surviving and can flourish even in the worst situations. With the sole aim of accelerating the growth of the electronics industry in India, the Expo focused not only on components and manufacturing equipment but the entire eco-system.

The three-day event took place at Pragati Maidan, New Delhi, from February 16 to 18. The Expo had bustling activities on all days and also led to some serious long-term business decisions, actualised by manufacturers and their buyers.

With over 12,000 'worthy' footfalls over three days, the event was a huge success. The Expo saw many happy exhibitors and satisfied visitors. Right from manufacturers and buyers to students, the Expo attracted all kinds of people related to the electronics indus-

try, from different parts of the country.

Over 450 leading brands exhibited the very best of their technologies at Hall No. 11. The Expo offered business opportunities in various electronics sectors including components, test and measurement equipment, training and educational solutions, PCB manufacturing, electronics manufacturing services (EMS) and electronics design.

A potent blend of seminars, conferences and summits running in parallel at the three-day event aimed to provide useful insights into the Indian electronics industry—for the benefit of design engineers, manufacturers and senior decision makers alike. Sachin Pilot, Minister of State for Communications and Information Technology, inaugurated the event.

Pilot released a report titled *ELCOMAS*, which was based on inputs from 540 electronics component manufacturers in India. Addressing the gathering of eminent personalities from the Indian electronics industry, Pilot said, "We are at least a decade late in starting initiatives like setting up electronics manufacturing clusters in India. There is no reason why we cannot make India the electronics manufacturing hub of the world. But

unless the industry itself is very competitive in quality and price, there is nothing any government can do."

He added, "The Indian electronics industry should ensure that its components and the products meet quality standards globally, and they should not be exorbitantly priced. We have to move simultaneously on all fronts. The Electronics Development Fund is worth Rs 50 billion, which can be availed by members of the Indian electronics industry." The minister also suggested that the electronics industry in India should work as a unit, which will help the ministry formulate better policies.

Aakash is the hottest topic in India right now, so it was but natural that there would be a discussion about this piece of technology—especially since it still remains an enigma to many. While revealing the mystery behind the world's cheapest tablet device, Dr Anupam Gupta from IIT Jodhpur, who is part of the team that designed the Aakash, disowned the design of DataWind's Aakash tablets currently being sold in the market. Giving the design lessons from the IIT Jodhpur team that designed the Aakash tablet, the professor said that among all



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